

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Model validation and model risk governance specialist with ~7 years of quantitative model development, validation, and governance experience, applying for the Associate Director, Enterprise Model Risk Management role at RBC. Holds delegated sign-off authority at Moody's Analytics on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (~\$50bn+ cumulative), and sits on the model governance committee shaping methodology, documentation, and benchmarking standards for client-delivered analytics. Proficient Python and SQL practitioner with Monte Carlo and stress-testing depth; CFA charterholder with dual MSc degrees in Financial Modelling and Chemical Engineering. OSFI E-23 / SR 11-7-aligned model-governance awareness.

CORE SKILLS

Model Validation & Independent Review • Model Risk Governance (OSFI E-23-aligned / SR 11-7-aligned) • Model Documentation & Benchmarking Standards • Model Performance Assessment & Challenge • Python (pandas, NumPy, SciPy) • SQL (PostgreSQL) & Data Analytics • Stochastic Modelling & Monte Carlo Simulation • Stress Testing & Scenario Analysis • Quantitative Risk Analytics (VaR / CVaR) • Validation Reporting to Senior Stakeholders • Git / Version Control & CI/CD • Cross-Functional Stakeholder Consensus

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Independent Model Review, Testing & Challenge

- Held delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement; ~\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Validated derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, cross-checking sensitivity consistency at portfolio-level aggregates.
- Reviewed aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics feeding downstream ALM and capital processes.
- Escalated outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility - held one client release 48 hours until a curve-calibration edge case was diagnosed, remediated upstream, and captured in standing validation tests.

Model Governance, Documentation & Validation Reporting

- Contributed as a member of the model governance committee to methodology review, model documentation and benchmarking standards, and model performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Operated within a formal model governance framework - assessing assumptions, testing economic defensibility, and building documentation standards consistent with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23-style expectations.
- Produced analytical summaries for senior stakeholders on scenario impacts and balance-sheet sensitivities, converting quantitative findings into conclusions and recommendations for Heads of Risk and investment committees.

Quantitative Development, Python & Data Analytics

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios across ALM horizons.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation, and auditability controls; ran shadow-mode reconciliation for two cycles before cutover.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and anomaly detection, reducing development cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe DB (risk & ALM) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management) platforms; validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Translated client investment-team requirements into structured development requests, working between client stakeholders and product owners to reach agreed specifications.

Ernst & Young (EY)**Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk**

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with system implementation and financial-reporting frameworks.
- Contributed to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes; coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, and risk functions on milestone delivery.

Ortec Finance Canada**Consultant - ALM & Risk**

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators (Monte Carlo) assessing interest-rate risk and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition and near-optimal frontier analysis to test the robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Presented ALM study findings to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients on-site.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016